CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 06

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Growing Up in a Digital World

Today's children are often called 'digital natives' because they cannot remember a time before smartphones and the internet. A child of eight can open an app, take a photograph and watch a video with more ease than many grandparents. This has brought many benefits. Students can look up information in seconds, join online classes, learn languages and share their work with friends far away.

But a screen is like a sharp knife: very useful in careful hands and harmful in careless ones. Doctors warn that hours of continuous gaming or scrolling can tire the eyes, strain the neck and spoil sleep. Children who spend most of their free time on screens may also have less time for play, hobbies and talking to family members. Some become easily irritated when they are asked to put the phone away.

There are other dangers. Strangers can pretend to be friends on the internet, and personal details shared carelessly can be misused. Not everything on the web is true, either; false news and edited pictures spread rapidly. Young users must therefore learn to ask questions before they believe or share anything. Who wrote it? Is it from a reliable source? Would I be comfortable if my parents saw it?

The solution is balance, not a total ban. A family can agree on screen-free hours, such as meal times and the hour before bed. Children should be encouraged to play outdoors, read printed books and pursue creative hobbies. Parents, for their part, should remember that children learn by example; a father who is always on the phone can hardly ask his son to put his away. Technology is a good servant but a bad master, and it is up to each of us to decide which role it will play.

(i) The term 'digital natives' refers to: 1

(a) children who have always known smartphones and the internet **(b)** people who live in villages

(c) elderly users **(d)** computer engineers

(ii) The writer compares a screen to: 1

(a) a book **(b)** a mirror

(c) a sharp knife **(d)** a window

(iii) Which of these is NOT a harm of too much screen time? 1

(a) improved fitness **(b)** tired eyes

(c) less family time **(d)** spoilt sleep

(iv) Before sharing news online, a young user should: 1

(a) share it quickly (b) edit it
(c) ignore it (d) check whether the source is reliable

(v) 'Technology is a good servant but a bad master' means that technology: 1

(a) is always harmful (b) should rule our lives
(c) is useful when we control it (d) should be avoided

(vi) State whether True or False: The writer suggests banning all screens for children. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Mention two benefits of the internet for students. 1

(viii) Why can sharing personal details online be dangerous? 1

(ix) Name two screen-free times a family can agree on. 1

(x) Why can a father who is always on the phone hardly ask his son to put his away? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

A Cup of Tea for the Guard

Every morning at five, when the platform of Jaipur Junction was still half asleep, Ramesh the tea-seller set up his stall beside the ticket office. He had a battered kettle, a stack of paper cups and a cheerful voice that rang through the empty station: "Chai, garam chai!"

His first customer was always the same: Mr Qureshi, the old railway guard, who waved his green flag for the early train to Delhi. He drank his tea standing up and never spoke more than three words. "One cup, thanks." For six years that was the whole of their conversation.

One morning in July, the guard did not come. Nor did he come the next day. Ramesh found himself looking toward the platform again and again, and on the fourth day he asked a porter where Mr Qureshi was. "In the hospital," said the porter. "He had a fall. Poor man has nobody to look after him."

That evening, after closing, Ramesh bought a flask, filled it with the best tea he could make and took the bus to the hospital. He found Mr Qureshi lying in a corner bed, staring at the ceiling. When he saw the flask, the old guard's face lit up. "Chai, garam chai," Ramesh said softly, and for the first time in six years, the two men laughed together.

Ramesh came every evening until the guard was well. When Mr Qureshi finally returned to the platform, he did not say "One cup, thanks." Instead, he said, "Two cups, my friend. Today you must sit with me."

(i) Ramesh set up his stall at: 1

(a) five in the morning (b) noon
(c) eight in the evening (d) midnight

(ii) Mr Qureshi was a: 1

(a) doctor (b) railway guard
(c) porter (d) tea-seller

(iii) Mr Qureshi did not come because he: 1

(a) disliked the tea (b) had a fall and was in hospital
(c) had retired (d) was on holiday

(iv) The line 'for the first time in six years, the two men laughed together' shows that: 1

(a) they had quarrelled (b) the tea was too hot
(c) they were angry (d) their relationship had become warmer

(v) The story teaches us that: 1

(a) tea is healthy
(b) small acts of kindness build friendships
(c) guards are lonely
(d) hospitals are costly

(vi) State whether True or False: Mr Qureshi and Ramesh had long conversations every day. Correct if false. 1

(vii) What did Ramesh carry to the hospital? 1

(viii) How long had Ramesh been serving the guard? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'damaged by long use'. 1

(x) What did Mr Qureshi say when he returned to the platform? What does it show? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND